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The Human Impact

Before you do anything, stop, and recall the face of the poorest, most helpless, destitute person you have seen, and ask yourself 'Is what I am about to do, going to help him?'

– Mahatma Gandhi

On the day demonetization was announced, my mother and I had just arrived in Delhi, breaking journey for a few days on our way to Ajmer and Pushkar. The note ban had us scrambling to try and exchange notes to manage expenses for our travel. It proved to be more difficult than we imagined, and we each spent several hours in bank queues – only to end up with a few unusable ₹2,000 notes.

Describing the scenes outside banks, *The New York Times* reported: